

Confucius

The Chinese **PHILOSOPHER** who accidentally started a new religion

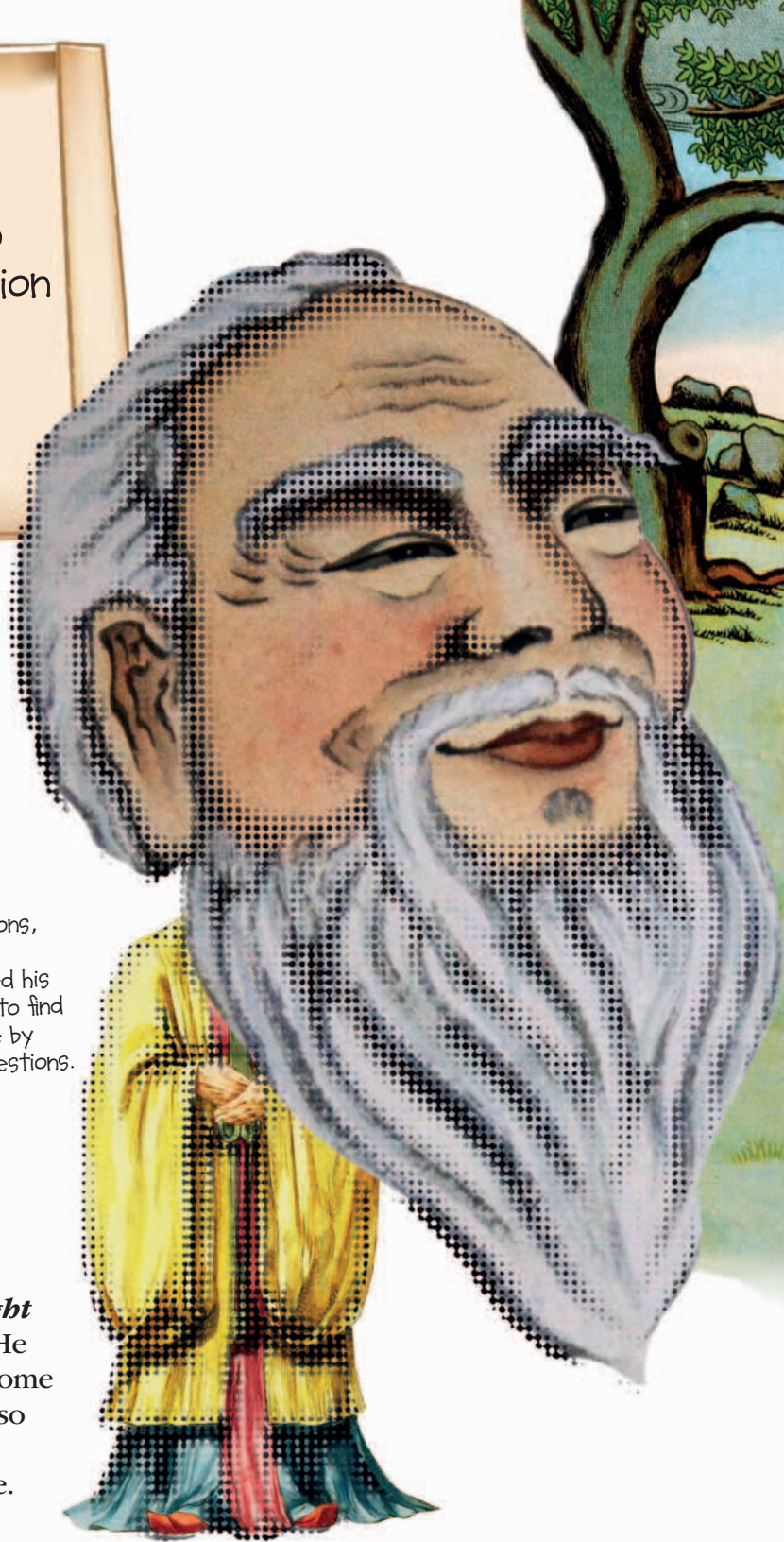
Confucius taught China's rulers to take better care of their people. His simple yet powerful ideas still influence governments today.

Scraping a living

Confucius was born in 551 BCE near Qufu, China. His once rich **aristocratic** family had fallen on **HARD TIMES**, so Confucius did many things to earn a living, including working as a shepherd and bookkeeper.



In his lessons, Confucius encouraged his students to find knowledge by asking questions.



Path to knowledge

Confucius began teaching when he was about 30 years old. He believed that **everyone had the right to education** no matter what their social standing. He opened a **SCHOOL** in his home and even allowed some of his poorer students to live with him. Confucius also worked as a minor official in the state of Lu, but he quickly became **concerned** about what he saw there.

He paved the way for...

The philosopher **MENCIUS** (390–305 BCE) developed Confucius's teachings, and declared that people had the **RIGHT TO OVERTHROW AN UNJUST RULER**.

SHI HUANGDI (259–210 BCE), used Confucius's ideas to unify China and become its first emperor. He also built the **GREAT WALL OF CHINA**.

